

Holly the Hedgehog's Gentle Hug

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Holly was a small brown hedgehog. She lived under a mossy log. Holly had soft fur on her tummy. But her back was covered in prickles. Sharp little prickles. Holly loved her friends very much. She loved Monty the mouse. She loved Fern the frog. But Holly never gave hugs. She was afraid her prickles would poke. "I would hurt them," she whispered. Holly felt sad. She wanted to hug more than anything.



One afternoon, Monty the mouse came to visit. He brought blackberry jam sandwiches. "Thank you for sharing your log with me," said Monty. Then Monty opened his arms wide. "Can I have a hug, Holly?" Holly's heart went thump thump. She felt scared. Her prickles stood up straight. "I might poke you," she said. Monty smiled. "We will find a gentle way," he said. "Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." "Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." Holly repeated it softly. "Gentle and slow, that's the way to go." It became their special saying.



Monty showed her a trick. "First, I hug your soft tummy side," he said. "Then you wrap your little arms around me." "And we go gentle and slow." Holly tried it. She turned her soft side toward Monty. She wrapped her arms around him. Gentle and slow. It worked! No pokes at all. Just a warm, cozy hug. Holly felt happy. She felt brave. "I did it!" she squeaked.



Can you give yourself a gentle hug? Wrap your arms around you, gentle and slow. Just like Holly. Next, Fern the frog hopped over. "Hug for me too?" she asked. Holly nodded. She used her trick again. Gentle and slow. Fern giggled. "Best hug ever," said Fern. Holly hugged all her friends that day. Each hug was gentle and slow.



That night, the moon rose round and bright. Holly curled into a ball under her log. Monty snuggled beside her, safe from prickles. "Goodnight, gentle hugger," he whispered. Holly smiled in her sleep. She dreamed of soft hugs, warm and slow. And she slept the whole night through.

***Moral:** There is always a gentle way to show love.*

The End